

Ὀρειβάσιος ὁ Περγαμηνός

Oribasius of Pergamon and the Medical Collections

eul_aid: soi

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Ἰατρική [Medicine](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Oribasius was a Greek physician from Pergamon who lived during the 4th and early 5th centuries CE. He studied medicine in Alexandria and became the personal physician and close advisor to the Roman Emperor Julian. Following Julian's death, Oribasius was exiled but was later recalled, living a long life that spanned a major transition in the Roman Empire.

He was not primarily an original medical thinker but a prolific compiler. At Emperor Julian's request, he undertook a massive project to collect and preserve Greek medical knowledge. His most famous work is the Medical Collections, a vast encyclopedia in 70 books, though only about a third of it survives. He also wrote the Synopsis, a complete nine-book handbook for practical use, and the Euporista, a collection of simple remedies.

Modern scholars regard Oribasius as a figure of crucial historical importance for the transmission of medical knowledge. His systematic compilations, which faithfully followed the teachings of Galen, served as essential reference works for later Byzantine and Arabic physicians. Through these works, he helped safeguard the medical heritage of antiquity, acting as a vital link between the ancient Greco-Roman world and the medicine of the Middle Ages.

Works (6)

- Βιβλία πρὸς Εὐνάπιον · [Books to Eunapius](#) · 1851 passages
- Ἰατρικαὶ Συλλογαί · [Medical Collections, Books 1–16, 24–25, 43–50](#) · 7405 passages
- Ἰατρικαὶ Συλλογαί · [Medical Collections, Uncertain Books](#) · 881 passages
- Ἐπιλογαὶ Φαρμάκων · [Selections of Medicines](#) · 900 passages
- Σύνοψις πρὸς Εὐστάθιον τὸν Υἱόν · [Summary to Eustathius the Son](#) · 2578 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · [Testimonies](#) · 1 passages